

Princeton High School
Science Magazine

THE CACTUS

WINTER 2026

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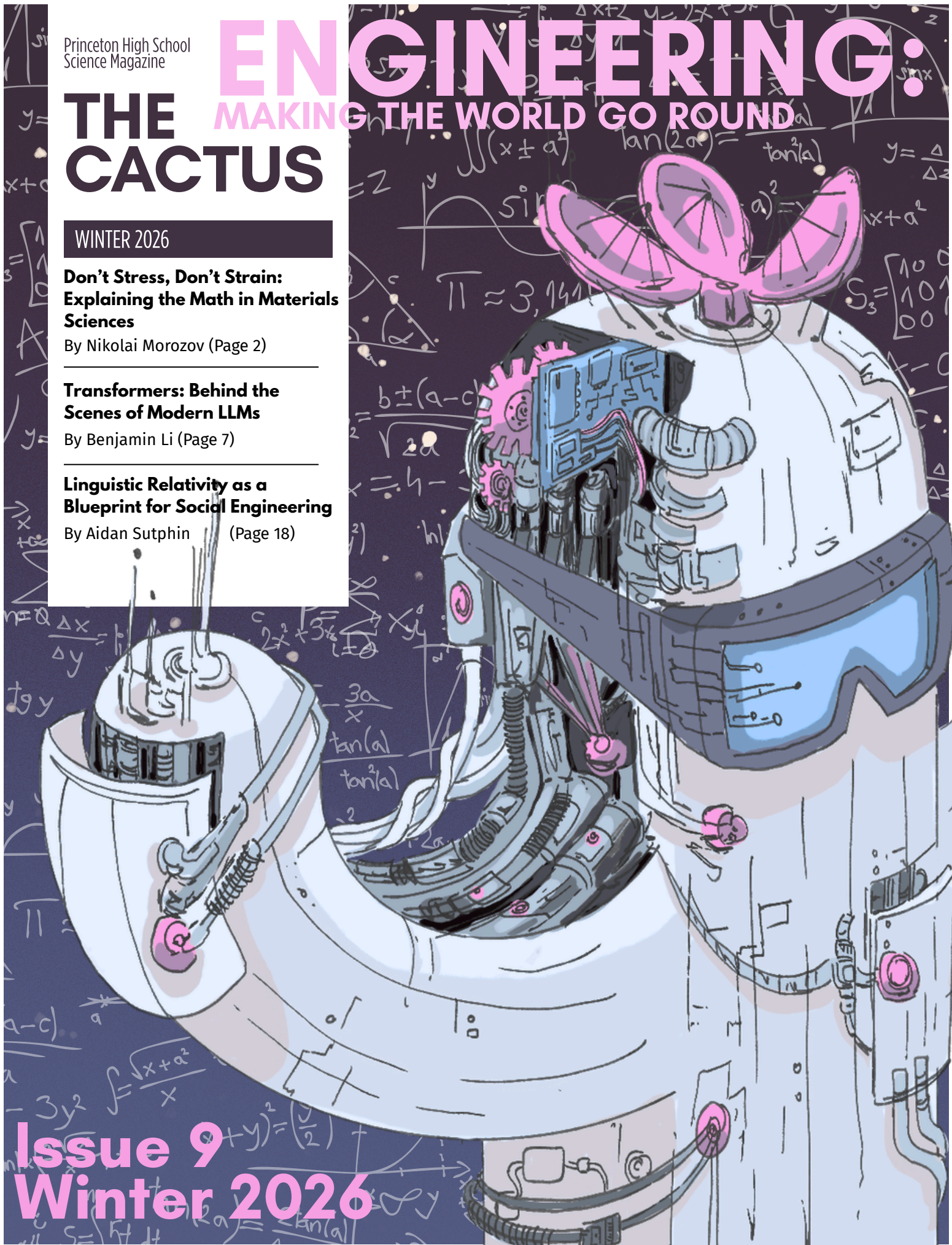
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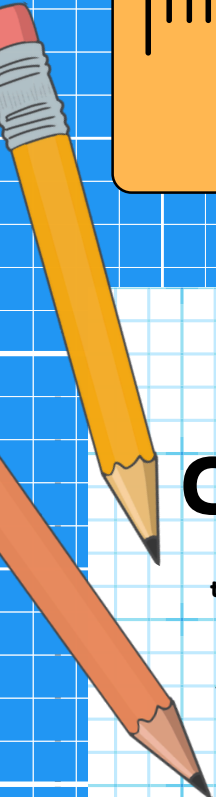
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ENGINEERING:

MAKING THE WORLD GO ROUND

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THE CACTUS

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EDITORS' LETTER

We don't exaggerate when we say that engineering is found everywhere. Derived from the Latin roots *Ingenium* (cleverness) and *Ingeniare* (to devise), engineering forms the basis of everything: simple ramps, surgical tools, vaccines, hurricane-proof towns, and even the way we communicate through 5G networks.

The *Ingenium* displayed by PHS students is inspiring. By questioning the mundane systems around us, we have discovered surprising insights that compel innovation.

High school is often characterized as a time of self-exploration, which is driven by curiosity and inquiry. The basis of all innovation, of self and of technology, stems from the driven minds of our humanity, continuously asking "what if" and daring to search for answers.

In a way, the founding of the Cactus and its continued success was built on top of the strong foundational curiosity found within the PHS community. We are constantly surrounded by peers who dare to push their limits and challenge their minds that makes creations like the Cactus possible. As we approach the third anniversary of the Cactus and begin to think about long term goals—a change in staff, writers, leaders, and artists, and the vast field of possibilities our curiosities have yet to explore—we hope that this issue can remind us of our efforts and accomplishments that brought us to where we are today through an appreciation of past innovation.

To showcase humanity's ingenuity of engineering through the ingenuity of PHS students, we welcome our readers to the second issue of the 2025-2026 cycle, *Engineering: Making the World Go Round*.

Joanna & Hojung